

Pros and cons of ClamAV

Pros

- Compatible with major operating systems like Windows, Linux, or macOS, etc.
- It has an open source virus database and can be used for research or improvement purposes.
- Mail gateway scan is possible.
- Multi-threaded virtual scanner against malware.
- The utility command line allows easy navigation.
- This antivirus is free and any custom GUI front-end can be connected to it.

Cons

- Limited functionality and focuses mainly on mail gateway protection.
- No support service.
- Not simple to use and needs various configurations with a command line utility.

80.28 per cent of viruses. Another antivirus testing company called *bestantiviruspro.org* reviewed and gave a 5 star (value for money) rating with a score of 72 per cent to ClamAV in 2021, when compared with other commercial antiviruses like Comodo, Windows Defender, Eset and Sophos.

ClamAV architecture

ClamAV works mainly with a virus detection service, virus database and the *freshclam* tool. The *freshclam* tool helps ClamAV to update its database, and it can be configured using the *freshclam.conf* file. This tool can be configured to work either in interactive (on demand from command line) mode or daemon (silently in the background) mode. It supports scripted updates (instead of transferring the whole CVD file at each update, it only transfers the differences between the latest and the current database via a special script), database version checks through DNS, proxy servers (with authentication), digital signatures and various error scenarios.

The virus database is updated from the link <http://database.clamav.net> by downloading the .cvd files, and the updates can be automated by configuring the *freshclam* tool. The virus detection service is connected to the virus database along with the protection engine of ClamAV. Various GUI apps like WinClam and ClamTk can be used with the detection engine, but by default, ClamAV can be used with the help of a command line utility also.

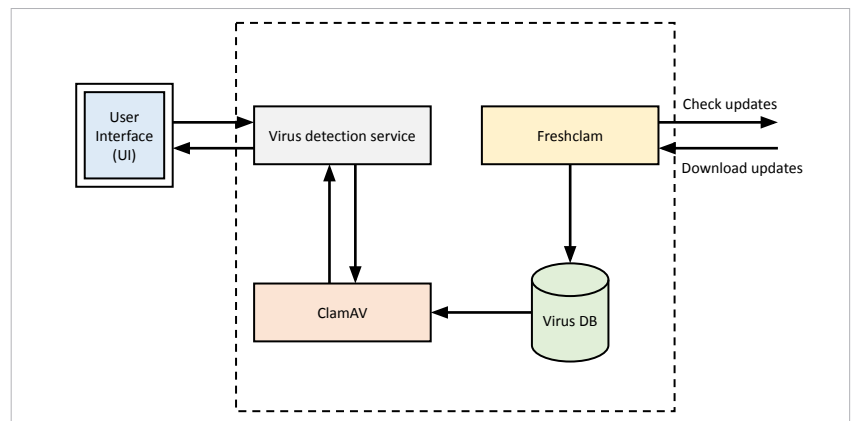


Figure 3: ClamAV architecture

The installation and configuration documents of ClamAV can be found at <https://www.clamav.net/documents> and you can also get community support for ClamAV at <https://stackoverflow.com>.

Features of ClamAV

The features of ClamAV include:

- A command line scanner.
- Milter interface for Sendmail.
- An advanced database updater, with support for scripted updates and digital signatures.
- The virus database gets updated multiple times in a day.
- Built-in support for all standard mail file formats.
- Built-in support for various archive formats, including Zip, RAR, Dmg, Tar, Gzip, Bzip2, OLE2, Cabinet, CHM, BinHex, SIS, and others.

- Built-in support for ELF executables and portable executable files packed with UPX, FSG, Petite, NsPack, wwpack32, MEW, Upack and obfuscated with SUE, Y0da Cryptor, and others.
- Built-in support for popular document formats including MS Office and MacOffice files, HTML, Flash, RTF and PDF.

An antivirus is a crucial part of a computer, without which it can be at the risk of malware infection. Using the right antivirus software will keep the computer safe from any malware attack and also protect vital data. However, not all antivirus software are helpful and choosing the right one is important. ClamAV could be the right one for you! **END** 🐧

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